

Experiment = To determine the modulus of rigidity of a wire by Maxwell's needle (Dynamic method)

Apparatus =

- Maxwell's needle
- a wire of suitable length and diameter
- stop watch
- torsion head
- telescope
- knitting needle fitted vertically on a stand
- screw gauge
- spring balance
- meter rod

Diagram =



Observation and Calculation =

Length of given wire = $L = 100.33$ cm

Total length of Maxwell's needle = $2l = 12$ cm

Half length of needle = $l = 6$ cm

Average mass of hollow cylinder = $m_1 = 12.5$ gm

Average mass of solid cylinder = $m_2 = 162.5$ gm

L.C of screw gauge = 0.01 mm

Zero Correction of screw gauge = Null mm

Experiment Name: **To determine the modulus of rigidity of a wire**
Maxwell's needle (dynamic method)

APPARATUS:-

- Maxwell's needle
- a wire of suitable length and diameter
- Stop watch
- torsion head
- meter rod
- knitting needle fitted vertically on a stand
- Telescope
- meter rod
- Spring balanced

Procedure:-

- Take a wire of suitable length and diameter. Remove the kinks by stretching the wire gently. Suspend the Maxwell's needle from one end of wire and fixed other end with rigid support.
- Arrange the apparatus so that mirror attaches to middle of Maxwell's needle faces towards a window and this needle hangs horizontally parallel to wall carrying support.
- Place the knitting needle on an upright in front of mirror.
- Place telescope in front of mirror at least 5 meter away from it and focus it at image of knitting needle.
- Put the hollow cylinder of Maxwell's needle inwards and solid cylinder outwards systematically in the tube.
- Displace one end of Maxwell's tube slightly backwards to make it vibrate in a horizontal plane.
- Start the stopwatch when image of needle just passes through vertical - cross wire. Count 1 when image

Corrected diameter of wire = 1) 0.041 cm 2) 0.042 cm

3) 0.0412 cm

Mean diameter of wire = $d =$ 0.041 cm

Radius of wire = $r = \frac{d}{2} =$ 0.0205 cm

Position of solid cylinder	No. of oscillation	Time for 20 Vibrations				Time period = $T = \frac{t}{20}$ sec
		1 sec	2 sec	3 sec	Mean t sec	
Outside	20	191	192	191.5	191.5	9.56
Inside	20	161	160	161	160.2	8.01

Calculation = Modulus of rigidity = $\frac{8\pi l (m_2 - m_1) L^2}{(T_1^2 - T_2^2) r^4}$

$$= \frac{8(3.14)(1003)(162.5 - 12.5)(6)^2}{[(9.56)^2 - (8.01)^2](0.0205)^4} = 7.1 \times 10^{11} \text{ dynes/cm}^2$$

Modulus of rigidity of given wire = 7.1×10^{11} dynes/cm²

Actual Value of $\eta =$ 8.9×10^{11} dynes/cm²

Percentage error = $\frac{\text{Actual Value} - \text{Calculated Value}}{\text{Actual Value}} \times 100$

= 20 %

crosses the vertical cross wire again.

- Now repeat the experiment by interchanging both cylinders inwards and both hollow cylinder outwards.
- Again find time for 20 vibrations and repeat it thrice.
- Measure the length of given wire b/w to torsion heads and length of maxwell's wire.
- Measure the masses of both hollow cylinder's and find out average mass m_1 of each hollow cylinder's. Same process for measuring mass m_2 of each solid cylinder.
- Calculate the modulus of rigidity;

$$\eta = \frac{8\pi l (m_2 - m_1) L^2}{(T_1^2 - T_2^2) r^4}$$

Precautions :-

- The wire free from kinks should be used.
- The amplitude of maxwell's needle should be small.
- The maxwell's needle should vibrate equally on both sides of reference needle and no up and down movement.
- Measure diameter of wire at various points.
- The needle should be protected from air-currents during performance of experiment.